

ETHAN VILLALOVOZ

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EDUCATION

Georgia Institute of Technology

Expected May 2028

M.S. in Computer Science (Computational Perception & Robotics) | GPA: 4.0/4.0

Atlanta, GA

- **Selected Coursework:** Robotics: AI Techniques, Computer Graphics (NeRF, 3D Gaussian Splatting, World Models)

Washington State University, Honors College

Aug 2021 – May 2025

B.S. in Computer Science, Minor in Mathematics | GPA: 3.94/4.0, Summa Cum Laude

Pullman, WA

EXPERIENCE

Georgia Institute of Technology

Feb 2026 – Present

Graduate Student Researcher

Atlanta, GA

- Adapting a **Wan2.2-TI2V-5B video-to-action codebase** to train and evaluate robot policies on **LIBERO** by adding dataset conversion, action normalization, and PyTorch/Hydra pipelines.

Microsoft

May 2026 – Jul 2026

Software Engineer Intern

Redmond, WA

- Built a C#/.NET 10 proof-of-concept **AI agent for financial close** using Azure AI Foundry, Azure OpenAI, and GraphQL APIs, giving users one natural-language interface to investigate blockers across multiple applications.
- Cut measured AI inference cost about **30×** while matching GPT-5.4 tool-routing quality by benchmarking 7 Azure OpenAI models, selecting GPT-5.4-nano, curating its tools, and correcting routing failures with targeted instructions.
- Increased agent throughput about **22×** (**0.5 to 11 requests/second**) by load-testing concurrency, tracing throttling to undersized Azure OpenAI capacity, and resizing the deployment with no observed throttling failures.
- Resolved **22 security findings** across two production repositories, including preventing unauthorized file access across four C# endpoints through layered path and permission validation backed by 67 tests.

Carnegie Mellon University

Jun 2024 – Aug 2024

Robotics Institute Summer Scholar

Pittsburgh, PA

- Developed a **Python Bayesian reward-learning simulation** for household robotics, modeling user preferences with hierarchical decision trees over object type, color, material, and placement.
- Implemented an **interactive MDP** that updated beliefs from simulated object-placement corrections and follow-up feature questions, ranking the ground-truth preference model highest in a rollout.

Google

May 2023 – Aug 2023

Software Engineering Intern (STEP)

Sunnyvale, CA

- Developed and deployed **5 C++/SQL statistics-collection jobs** for pending queues in an internal database, replacing manual analysis with automated metric reporting.
- Scaled statistics collection from **1% to 100% of the database in under 4 hours** by implementing incremental job sampling, reducing anticipated runtime by 66%.

PROJECTS

AV Planning & ML Workbench | Python/C++, JAX/PyTorch, Waymax/TensorRT, Angular/TS/FastAPI, Gemini

- Built a Waymax workbench to isolate planner regressions by replaying tested/reference planners on matched WOMB edits; Bayesian search raised eligible-proposal yield by **14.8 pp** vs. random search across **3,200 proposals**.

PUBLICATIONS

An Exploratory Study of Bayesian Prompt Optimization for Test-Driven Code Generation with Large Language Models. S. Tomar, A. Deshwal, **E. Villalovoz**, M. Fazzini, H. Cai, J. R. Doppa. *arXiv:2512.15076*, 2025.

Social Triangles and Aggressive Lines: Multi-Robot Formations Impact Navigation and Approach.

A. Bacula, **E. Villalovoz**, D. Flynn, A. Mehta, H. Knight. *IROS*, 2023.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages & Scripting: Python, C/C++, C#, SQL, TypeScript, JavaScript, Bash, PowerShell

AI/ML & Robotics: PyTorch, Hugging Face Transformers, scikit-learn, NumPy, FAISS, OpenCV, ROS

Web/Backend: .NET, ASP.NET Core, GraphQL, React, Next.js, FastAPI, Flask, REST APIs

Cloud & Tools: Microsoft Azure, Azure AI Foundry, Azure OpenAI, AWS, Docker, Git, GitHub Actions